HOUSEHOLD EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS

A practical planning and preparedness guide for households

GUIDE/VERIFY: This is a general preparedness guide, not a substitute for professional advice, local emergency-management instructions, manufacturer directions, medical guidance, or current public-health information. Conditions vary by location. Verify important information with authoritative sources before relying on it.

START HERE - HOUSEHOLD READINESS

- ■ Identify people, pets, medications, mobility needs, and other special considerations.
- ■ Know how to receive local emergency alerts and official information.
- ■ Choose an out-of-area contact and at least one meeting location.
- ■ Keep important documents accessible in physical and secure digital form.
- ■ Identify utility shutoffs and critical household systems.
- ■ Keep emergency supplies together where they can be found quickly.

BEFORE AN EMERGENCY

- ■ Check smoke and carbon-monoxide alarms.
- ■ Check fire extinguishers.
- ■ Secure heavy furniture and other fall hazards where appropriate.
- ■ Know how to safely shut off household utilities.
- ■ Review evacuation routes and local shelter information.
- ■ Plan for pets and service animals.

HOUSEHOLD INFORMATION

Household members/dependents: _____

- ■ Pets/animals: _____
- ■ Primary emergency contact: _____
- ■ Out-of-area contact: _____
- ■ Primary meeting place: _____
- ■ Alternate meeting place: _____
- ■ Important medical/accessibility needs: _____
- ■ Local emergency/non-emergency number: _____

KEY QUESTIONS

- What happens if the power is out for 24 hours?
- What if the water supply is interrupted?
- What if roads are blocked or evacuation is ordered?
- What if household members cannot use their phones?
- What if normal stores, fuel, or payment systems are unavailable?

WATER, FOOD & SANITATION

Plan for interruptions to normal household services.

WATER - PLAN & STORE

- Determine household drinking and basic sanitation needs.
- Store water in clean, food-safe containers or commercially packaged water.
- Label stored water with the date and follow container/manufacturer guidance.
- Keep some water available in a form that can be moved if evacuation is necessary.
- Know local guidance for emergency water advisories and boil-water notices.
- Do not assume clear water is safe to drink.

FOOD - BUILD A RESERVE

- Prioritize foods household members already eat and can prepare.
- Include shelf-stable foods requiring little or no refrigeration.
- Keep a manual can opener if canned food is used.
- Rotate stored food and use the oldest appropriate items first.
- Account for infants, allergies, medical diets, and pets.
- Plan a cooking method that does not depend on normal household power.

SANITATION

- Store soap, sanitizer, toilet paper, trash bags, disinfecting supplies, and personal hygiene items.
- Have a plan for human waste if normal plumbing is unavailable.
- Separate clean water from water intended for non-drinking uses.
- Use gloves and protective equipment when handling waste or contaminated materials.
- Follow local public-health guidance during outages, flooding, or water contamination.

HOUSEHOLD INVENTORY

- Stored drinking water: _____
- Shelf-stable food: _____
- Manual can opener: _____
- Sanitation supplies: _____
- Pet food/water: _____
- Special dietary supplies: _____
- Last inventory check: _____

HOUSEHOLD ACTION PLAN & VERIFICATION

Turn the information in this guide into decisions your household can actually use.

OUR TOP PRIORITIES

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

VERIFY LOCALLY

■ Local emergency management: _____

■ Local evacuation / shelter information: _____

■ Local weather alert system: _____

■ Local water advisories: _____

■ Local utility emergency information: _____

■ Other authoritative source: _____

NEXT 30 DAYS

■ Buy/replace missing supplies

■ Check alarms and extinguishers

■ Review evacuation routes

■ Complete household contact plan

■ Check water/food storage

■ Check lighting/batteries/charging

■ Review pet / medical needs

■ Review this document with household members

IMPORTANT: Preparedness information can become outdated. Equipment instructions, public-health recommendations, evacuation routes, utility procedures, and local emergency guidance can change. Review this guide periodically and verify critical information with current authoritative sources.

CRITICAL LIFE SAFETY REGULATION AND AUTHORITATIVE REFERENCE REGISTER

LEGAL AND COMPLIANCE DISCLAIMER NOTICE: THIS WORKSHEET IS AN INDEPENDENT PLANNING AID AND OPERATIONAL LOG BLUEPRINT, NOT A SUBSTITUTE FOR PROFESSIONAL STRUCTURAL SERVICES, LICENSED SAFETY DESIGN, CERTIFIED MEDICAL INSTRUCTION, MANUFACTURER DIRECTIONS, OR OFFICIAL LOCAL LAWS. EMERGENCY INFRASTRUCTURE RULES, MUNICIPAL ROUTING SCHEMES, AND CIVIL EVACUATION CORRIDORS ALTER ROUTINELY WITHOUT REVISION TIMELINES. IN AN ACTIVE DISRUPTION OR IMMINENT LIFE SAFETY THREAT, THE USER IS ORDERED TO SUSPEND PRIVATE ESTIMATES AND REFER DIRECTLY TO COMMAND PROCEDURES DICTATED BY AUTHORITATIVE PUBLIC EMERGENCY ORGANIZATIONS, INCLUDING THE FEDERAL EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT AGENCY (FEMA), THE CENTERS FOR DISEASE CONTROL AND PREVENTION (CDC), THE NATIONAL WEATHER SERVICE (NWS), THE AMERICAN RED CROSS, OR LOCAL MUNICIPAL RESCUE COUNCILS.

FIELD SOURCES AND AUTHORITATIVE TECHNICAL REFERENCES:

- Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) - Ready.gov
- Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC)
- National Weather Service (NWS)
- American Red Cross
- Your local emergency-management agency, utility providers, health department, and fire department